Beginning a message

We are writing to enquire about ….

I am writing in connection with …

We are interested in … and we would like to know …

Replying to a message

Thank you for your email of (date) asking if/enquiring about/enclosing/concerning

We have received your email of (date) asking if/enquiring about/enclosing/concerning

Ending a message

I look forward to receiving your reply/order/products/

Looking forward to hearing from you.

If you gave some information you can end a message with

I **hope that this information will help you. Please contact me if you need any further information.**

Referring

With reference to…/Further to…/I am writing in connection with…/With regard to…

Good News

I am (pleased/delighted/happy to tell/inform/advise) you that….

Bad News

We regret to (tell/advise/inform) you that…..

Saying what you can and cannot do

We are unable to … We are able to … We have been forced to …

Giving reasons

This is due to … This is owing to … This is as a result of … This is because of …

If you do not want to give the reason you can say *unforeseen circumstances* or *factors beyond our control*

To make a complaint

Unfortunately , we have not yet received…. Please could you…..

Making a point

I should like to draw your attention to the fact that … I should like to point out that …

If you are saying something that they already know

I should like to remind you that … I hope it is not necessary to remind you that …

Warning

Unless……., we well be forced to

Demand immediate action

We must insist, therefore, that you….

Give a warning

Unless we hear from you within seven days, we will take legal action

Requesting Action

Please could you… as soon as possible.

We would appreciate it if you could… immediately.

Apologizing

We must apologize for… **We apologize for…**

We are extremely sorry for… **Please accept our apologies for…**

(It is usually polite to apologize at the start, give the reason, then apologize again in the closing)

Please accept our apologies once again. **We hope that this has not caused you any inconvenience.**

Less formal emails talking about the last time contact happened

Thank you for your email. **It was a pleasure to see you again on…** **It was good to see you again.**

If you are writing to someone you know

I was wondering if you could help me. **I thought you might be interested to hear about…**

I am afraid we have a small problem. **I am afraid I have some bad news.**

I look forward to seeing you again next time I am in….

Inviting

We would be very pleased if you could join us at….

We have pleasure in inviting you to….

Accepting

I would be delighted to join you at…

I am very happy to accept your invitation to…

Declining

I would very much like to come, but unfortunately…

Unfortunately, I will not be able to join you because…

I am so sorry, but I cannot come to… because…